

Petro Knox Curriculum Vitae

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Product Leader | eCommerce | Marketplaces | SaaS | Operations

Product leader working across eCommerce, marketplaces, SaaS and operations, focused on solving customer and business problems and turning them into practical products and experiences. Over 20 years, I've worked hands-on across both sides of the problem, from running and improving businesses in hospitality and retail, through operations and project management, to building and delivering digital products across B2B, B2C and B2B2C environments. I bring together customer experience, commercial understanding, operational experience and hands-on product delivery. I'm comfortable working from the problem through to the detail of what needs to be built, and working closely with engineering and stakeholders to get it delivered.

Key Skills and Characteristics

Strategy & Discovery - Product strategy · Discovery · Roadmaps · Agile · Prioritisation

Customer & Experience - CX · UX/UI · Customer journeys · Conversion · User research

Digital Product - eCommerce · Marketplace · SaaS · Payments · APIs · Digital platforms

Delivery & Operations - Product delivery · Agile/Scrum · Waterfall · Process improvement · QA · Stakeholder management

Technical & AI - AI-assisted development · Technical product delivery · API integrations · Analytics

Work Experience

Product Delivery Lead | Placed Recruitment Ltd | March 2026 – Present

- Lead end-to-end product delivery across discovery, product definition, UX/UI, prototyping, testing, technical implementation and release.
- Drive the redesign and scaling of the recruitment platform, improving customer journeys, usability and product foundations for future growth.
- Build and validate prototypes using AI-assisted tools including ChatGPT, Claude and GitHub, supporting rapid experimentation and production deployment.
- Establish product ways of working, prioritisation and delivery processes while coordinating cross-functional stakeholders and technical dependencies.
- Operate across multiple product disciplines in a hands-on scale-up environment, combining Product Management, CX, UX/UI, quality assurance and technical problem-solving.

CX Product Owner Fruugo.com Ltd (Remote, UK) | June 2023 – July 2025

- Lead the product vision and execution for two teams for global Marketplace and Checkout impacting 42 countries and 24 languages.
- Managed teams OKRs, KPIs, and product roadmaps to drive strategic goals, improving conversion rates from 5% and reducing checkout abandonment by 4%.
- Spearheaded cross-functional teams in Lean Agile Scrum environments, leading delivering key SaaS and API product features (e.g., Apple Pay, Google Pay, PSP integration, Search optimization, Premium stores, UXUI).
- Utilising AI/ML -driven insights with observability, faster troubleshooting, search algorithms and data dashboards improving customer click-through to conversion rates.

- Collaborated with international internal and third-party teams, improving customer experience and business performance with strategic initiatives.

Product Owner Jacobs & Turner Ltd (Trespass), Glasgow, UK | July 2022 – May 2023

- Directed technical delivery of multiple eCommerce projects for B2C and DTOC markets using Agile methodologies.
- Led the product roadmaps and vision, working closely with senior stakeholders to align goals with business objectives by driving UX/UI improvements in user experience and integrations with third-party services leading to enhanced customer satisfaction.
- Using Elastic Suite for improved AI search algorithms decreasing bounce rate.
- Improved automated order management and shipping logistics with third party integrations, decreasing customer support WISMO by 75% in 4 weeks.

Founder and Business Owner Furry Kids Kitchen, Scotland, UK | March 2021 – June 2022

- Managed the full product lifecycle for pet food and treats, including NPD, market research, and recipe development.
- Led e-commerce design, digital marketing, and user experience improvements.
- Awarded the 2021 Scottish Agricultural Show Hamlyn's Baking Competition for innovation in pet food products and featured in Puppy Post October 2021 edition.

Career Transition July 2019–March 2021

- Relocated to Scotland, upskilled in nutrition and ASN, and aligned expertise with UK eCommerce regulations—paving the way for impactful roles at Furry Kids and beyond.

Founder and Director Urban Angel Café, Johannesburg, SA | May 2014 – May 2019

- Founded and scaled a top-rated café, achieving a 4.7-star rating and Gold TripAdvisor certification through customer-focused operational and product innovation.
- Managed website design, maintenance, and digital marketing, launching a platform that drove 25% brand visibility growth and YoY revenue increase.
- Directed Waterfall projects for store renovations and new location buildouts, consistently meeting project deadlines and budget constraints.
- Featured on Secret Eats with Adam Richmond, published in Good Food magazine, received a RASA Rosette Award for service Excellence in 2018.

Hospitality Sales Manager BankServAfrica, Johannesburg, SA | January 2013 – April 2014

- Developed and implemented sales strategies for hospitality sector, managing key accounts and driving revenue growth.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to integrate payment solutions, optimizing operational efficiency.

QSR Product Manager Famous Brands Ltd – t/a Debonairs Pizza, Johannesburg, SA | April 2010 – December 2012

- Managed product inventory databases and first-to-market e-commerce, mobile application and self-service terminal platform strategies.
- Increased online sales by 30% through strategic Agile project implementations.
- Menu costing matrix, pricing and maintenance managing National GP averages
- Implemented and coordinated projects for flawless national and international menu launches.

Operations and Project Manager Fournos Bakery, Johannesburg, SA | August 2005 – March 2010

- Maintained effective operations, coordinating personnel policies and procedures in line with company KPIs.
- Led operational oversight, business development, and process improvements, troubleshooting issues and implementing solutions.
- Managed product inventory databases, bakery and retail costing matrix, and pricing across the group.
- Directed Waterfall projects for new stores and renovations, delivering on-time and in-budget, growing the business from 5 to 10 stores.

Previous Roles Johannesburg, SA | 2001 – 2005

- Restaurant Manager, St John's Virgin Coffee Shop: Managed daily operations and functions.
- Function Co-ordinator, Rave Caterers: Coordinated film catering and festival functions.
- Admin Clerk (Part-time), Roberts & Co: Handled office administration and accounting.
- Assistant Restaurant Manager (Part-time), Ocean Basket Bright Water Commons: Supported restaurant management.

Education

- Master in Business Administration (MBA) – Abertay University, Dundee (September 2024 to Present)
- B.Com Degree in Marketing & Business Management – Damelin College, Oxford Brookes Recognized (2008)
- Diploma in Hotel and Restaurant Management – The Swiss Hotel School (2001)
- Diploma in Photoshop NQF Level 5 – Shaw Academy (2017)
- Certifications and Training
 - Scrum Product Owner Training – Stone River eLearning (June 2024)
 - Presentation Training – Second Nature by Sally Measom (April 2024)
 - Project Management Course (Refresher) – Udemy (March 2022)
 - Effective Speaking and Presentation Course – Maurice Kerrigan (2011)
 - Emotional Intelligence Course – Dr. Rina de Klerk-Weyer and Dr. Ronel le Roux (2009)
 - Business Management Workshop – Famous Brands Ltd (2008)

Volunteer Work

- Secretary for Parent Council and School Fund committees – Crosshouse Primary School (2025 – Present)
- Treasurer for Parent Council – Crosshouse Primary School (2023 – 2025)
- Parent Council Member – Crosshouse Primary School (2020 – 2023)
- Chairperson – Kenani Estate (2010 – 2016)